

Q. What are the initial challenges that contributors have to overcome when picking up projects?

A. First, you should be very serious about your contribution. There are no written commitments and contributors may tend to take the work lightly. That's totally wrong. Try to dedicate 8-10 hours or whatever is feasible each day. If you are skipping this commitment because you feel there are no immediate returns, then you will not be a good contributor.

Always adhere to a mentor's guidance strictly at the initial stages. This is very crucial for a healthy contribution. Sometimes it may happen that you believe you are good at something, while your mentor may not assign a project based on that skill. Simply approach your mentor in such scenarios and ask him what you should do, what is your role, and how you can contribute.

Q. Many developers do not get replies after submitting the contribution to a project. How does one make a submission noticeable?

A. Write a small blog on the project you are planning to contribute to, covering aspects like what you like in it, what you don't like, and what can be improved. Such a positive and promotional approach can greatly help you.

Be a part of the group and be involved in activities related to that particular project. Instead of contributing, first try to engage with the group, and this will increase the chances for you to get adopted as a contributor.

Once you have a better understanding of the project, not only will your work be accepted but you will be able to better align yourself with that project.

Q. How do you overcome a situation where your contribution is not accepted?

A. Just understand that this can happen for many reasons — maybe you are not in the right project or you have not contributed correctly. If the project is country driven, your request may not be accepted. Hence,

remember to have a checklist as stated earlier. Don't worry if your contribution is not accepted because either you are not fit for the project or the project is not fit for you.

All I would recommend is try to identify four or five projects, and at least one among those projects you work on will probably be accepted.

Q. What is your message for our readers?

A. Open source is the driving force behind most of the innovation happening today. Instead of just using open source, let us try to contribute according to our capacity and skills. Contributions can be in terms of code, documentation, testing, blogs, money, etc. It's time to contribute.

Q. Any hiring plans for ElectroMech Corporation — what are the roles and skill expectations?

We have requirements in cloud DevOps, and are hiring cloud architects, Python developers, Linux architects and security professionals. **END** 

OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2022-23

Month	Theme
March 2022	Security, Network Management and Monitoring
April 2022	Open Source Programming (Languages and tools)
May 2022	DevOps Special
June 2022	AI, Deep learning and Machine Learning
July 2022	Database management and Optimisation
August 2022	Cloud Special: Everything from management to implementation
September 2022	Mobile/Web App Development, Optimisation and Security
October 2022	Blockchain and Open Source
November 2022	Open Source and IoT and Edge
December 2022	Data science, Data security, Data Management, Storage and Backup
January 2023	Docker and containers
February 2023	Open Source on Windows and Best in the world of Open Source (Tools and Services)